

SendKit vs Woodpecker

The short version: Woodpecker is the agency-operations veteran of this category, and its unlimited-seats, unlimited-mailboxes stance is genuinely customer-friendly. The catch is that everything else is a meter: pay per contacted prospect, per warmup (\$5/mailbox), per LinkedIn account (\$29), per client (\$27 panel + \$5 white-label reporting), \$59 per resold "dedicated server," and even \$20/month for the API, MCP, and CLI. And underneath the meters there's no sending infrastructure of Woodpecker's own. SendKit is one flat price on infrastructure we actually run: dedicated IPs, isolation, native warmup, blacklist monitoring, placement testing, with the CLI and a hosted MCP included.

	SendKit	Woodpecker
Sending infrastructure	Dedicated IPs and fully isolated sending on every plan, from \$99	None of its own, sends through your mailboxes; "dedicated servers" are resold Infraforge at \$59/mo each
Pricing model	Flat platform price	Usage meters: ~\$35/mo per 500 contacted prospects, plus add-ons for LinkedIn, warmup, mailboxes, clients, and the developer stack
Warmup	Native: guardrails tuned per mailbox type, plus a high-quality seed pool used only with your mailboxes. Included	Third-party (Mailivery); 2 free, then \$5/mailbox/mo, \$250/mo at 50 mailboxes
Email validation	Built in, every plan	Built in (Bouncer-powered) with unlimited catch-all checks, credit where due
Blacklist monitoring	Built in, real-time	Not offered, their "blacklist" is a suppression list, not monitoring
Inbox placement testing	Built in, every plan	Not offered, their own deliverability guide points users to external tools
Health controls	Per-mailbox visibility, auto-pause when health drops	Adaptive Sending throttles near ESP limits; alerting, not auto-remediation
CLI + MCP	Both. Hosted, unmetered, included on every plan, with smart routing and 5-10x higher rate limits	Both exist, credit for shipping them, but they sit in a \$20/mo add-on bundle, and the MCP must be self-hosted via Docker
AI reply handling	AI reply agent reads, tags, and auto-responds above your confidence threshold	Interest detection and reply sorting only, English-only; no reply agent
White-label	Full platform, from \$499: reports, login, URL, API, logo, colors	Reporting app only, \$5/mo per active client, on top of the \$27/client Agency Panel

WHAT YOU GET WITH SENDKIT THAT WOODPECKER DOESN'T HAVE

- **An actual sending layer.** Dedicated IPs and isolated infrastructure on every plan, not a \$59/month-per-server resale of someone else's infrastructure.
- **Blacklist monitoring.** Real-time alerts when any sending IP hits a blacklist. Woodpecker has nothing watching.
- **Native warmup, included.** Woodpecker's warmup is a third-party network billed per mailbox; at agency scale that line item alone can exceed a SendKit plan.
- **Inbox placement testing built in, Woodpecker's own guide sends you to external tools for this.**

- **Per-mailbox auto-pause.** Adaptive throttling is prevention; SendKit also acts when a mailbox's health actually drops.
- **AI reply agent.** Reads and tags every reply in any language, auto-responds above your confidence threshold, Woodpecker stops at English-only interest labels.
- **New-gen CLI + MCP connection, hosted and included flat.** Woodpecker charging \$20/month for API + MCP + CLI, with the MCP self-hosted in Docker, tells you how they see it: an add-on. For us it's the interface: run campaigns, leads, replies, and a hundred other things from Claude, your terminal, or your own scripts, no meter.
- **One price instead of six meters.** No per-contacted-prospect charge, no per-warmup, no per-LinkedIn-account, no per-client panel fees. Unlimited workspaces and team members.

CLEAR EXPECTATIONS: WHAT YOU GET

- Low bounce rate and better deliverability
- Better time to lead from the reply agent and reply system
- Better white-label report system and custom GTM reporting
- Better inbox pricing and diversification across Google, Microsoft, and Azure mailboxes
- Better scaled pricing on higher volumes. The platform is made for scale
- Better advanced settings for sending management
- Faster inbox loading for faster time to lead
- Unlimited workspaces and team members with custom roles
- A way clearer, easier platform, built for heavy Claude users

WHERE WOODPECKER IS STRONG: Unlimited seats and unlimited connected mailboxes free is a genuinely fair stance. The Agency Panel (\$27/client) is the most mature client-management workflow in the category, separate client databases, client-owned mailbox connections, automated domain audits. And they did ship a real API, MCP, and CLI, which most legacy sequencers haven't.

WHAT WOODPECKER USERS REPORT

G2 4.3/5 ACROSS 73 REVIEWS, THE LOWEST G2 RATING IN THIS FAMILY, FULL CORPUS MINED 2026-07-12; TRUSTPILOT 2.5/5 "POOR"

- On G2, support is the most-mentioned dislike, 15 of 73 mined answers, roughly 1 in 5: "Price could be lower when we compare to competitors."
- Hidden costs: "easy to end up paying for things you didn't clearly intend to buy"; "key costs buried behind multiple confirmations."
- The outsourced warmup is the sharpest theme: it "sends bizarre, off-brand emails from your real address... without your knowledge."
- "Absolutely no refund policy," defensive support, and "very expensive for what it is."

Switching takes about 30 minutes. API key in, campaigns, sequences, and leads transfer automatically. Most teams finish in about 30 minutes. Mailboxes bought through InboxKit move in one step. Want the step-by-step? Ask for the **Cold Email Platform Migration Kit**.

[Bring your setup to a live demo](#)

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Comparing other platforms too? We keep the same honest head-to-heads for **Smartlead**, **Instantly**, **EmailBison**, **Lemlist**, **Apollo**, and more, reply and name the platform, and we'll send that one over. Also useful: **Why SendKit** (the full picture) and **State of Cold Email 2026** (the benchmark data behind these numbers).

